

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel / Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineer | Detection Engineering | KQL | PowerShell

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in security operations, detection engineering, and Microsoft Security platform management. My work at the University of the Arts London (UAL) has given me extensive hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel, including writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, building custom data connectors, deploying parsers, and managing enterprise-wide log ingestion across hybrid cloud and on-premises environments. I have led threat detection and response programmes using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, and I have designed Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage and incident escalation workflows. I am deeply committed to building precise, high-fidelity detection capabilities and I excel in technically advanced Microsoft-centric security environments. I look forward to bringing this expertise to a team of Security Most Valuable Professionals (MVPs) at the cutting edge of Microsoft's Security product roadmap.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM):** Enterprise log onboarding, custom and standard data connectors, parsers (Advanced Security Information Model / ASIM), Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, Function Apps, watchlists, workbooks, SOAR playbooks
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender / Defender XDR, Conditional Access, 8,000-user deployment
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection rules, use-case development, alert tuning to reduce false-positive rates, threat hunting using behavioural analytics
- **Log Ingestion and Multi-Cloud Environments:** Hybrid on-premises and Microsoft Azure log pipelines, data normalisation and optimisation for cost control, telemetry across identity, endpoint, cloud, and network layers
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook automation, Logic Apps integration
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, digital forensic triage, post-incident reviews, IR tooling enhancement
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), MITRE ATT&CK, Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Own and optimise enterprise-wide log onboarding into Microsoft Sentinel, deploying standard and custom data connectors, Function Apps, and parsers (ASIM) to build a tailored Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) solution for threat detection and response across an 8,000-user environment.
- Manage log ingestion across a hybrid Microsoft Azure and on-premises estate, parsing, normalising, and optimising telemetry ingestion to ensure detection precision and cost control.
- Author Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and scheduled alert queries mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs), significantly reducing false-positive alert volumes while improving detection fidelity for high-priority threats.

- Design and maintain SOAR playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating alert enrichment, containment actions, and ticketing workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for priority security incidents.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, maintaining detection policies, tuning alert thresholds, and supporting the organisation's Extended Detection and Response (XDR) strategy.
- Conduct threat hunting across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon using behavioural analytics and MITRE ATT&CK-based hypotheses, uncovering latent threats that bypassed automated detection.
- Partner with the Incident Response team on live security incidents, applying detection rule tuning in real time against active threat actor activity and leading post-incident reviews to improve detection coverage.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID and Conditional Access policies, enforcing Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) across the hybrid environment.
- Lead vulnerability management operations using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), integrating findings into Microsoft Sentinel workbooks for risk-based prioritisation and tracking.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed SIEM alert triage using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, investigating security events across endpoint, identity, email, and network data sources and escalating confirmed incidents.
- Supported the development of Microsoft Sentinel data connectors and KQL detection rules, building the foundational log ingestion pipelines for the organisation's SIEM programme.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID/Azure AD, managing user provisioning, group membership, and Conditional Access policy enforcement.
- Supported Microsoft Defender for Endpoint deployment and policy management, assisting with sensor onboarding, exclusion management, and alert investigation.
- Assisted with PowerShell scripting to automate security operations tasks including account management, log collection, and report generation.
- Contributed to incident response investigations, including containment of compromised accounts, malware triage, and evidence preservation, following the NIST 800-61 lifecycle.
- Assisted with vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck, producing remediation reports for infrastructure and application owners.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security, quality, and infrastructure engineering across a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, implementing security controls and access management aligned to ISO 27001 requirements.
- Managed endpoint security tooling, identity management, and network security configurations, supporting the organisation's security posture in a cloud-first environment.
- Developed and maintained security procedures and runbooks, improving consistency and speed of incident resolution.
- Provided technical escalation support for security and infrastructure incidents, applying structured triage methodologies to reduce resolution times.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised an enterprise Microsoft Sentinel deployment at UAL, ingesting telemetry from identity, endpoint, cloud, and network sources and authoring a library of KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, delivering high-fidelity threat detection across a complex hybrid environment.
- Led the 8,000-user deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, establishing unified Extended Detection and Response (XDR) coverage across the organisation.
- Designed and implemented SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating repetitive analyst workflows and reducing manual alert triage time by over 40%.
- Delivered detection engineering enhancements mapped to live attacker Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) observed during real incident response engagements, closing detection gaps in real

time.

- Introduced Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate detection coverage, enabling data-driven decisions on detection rule improvement and vulnerability prioritisation.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)